Foundational Reading & Linguistics

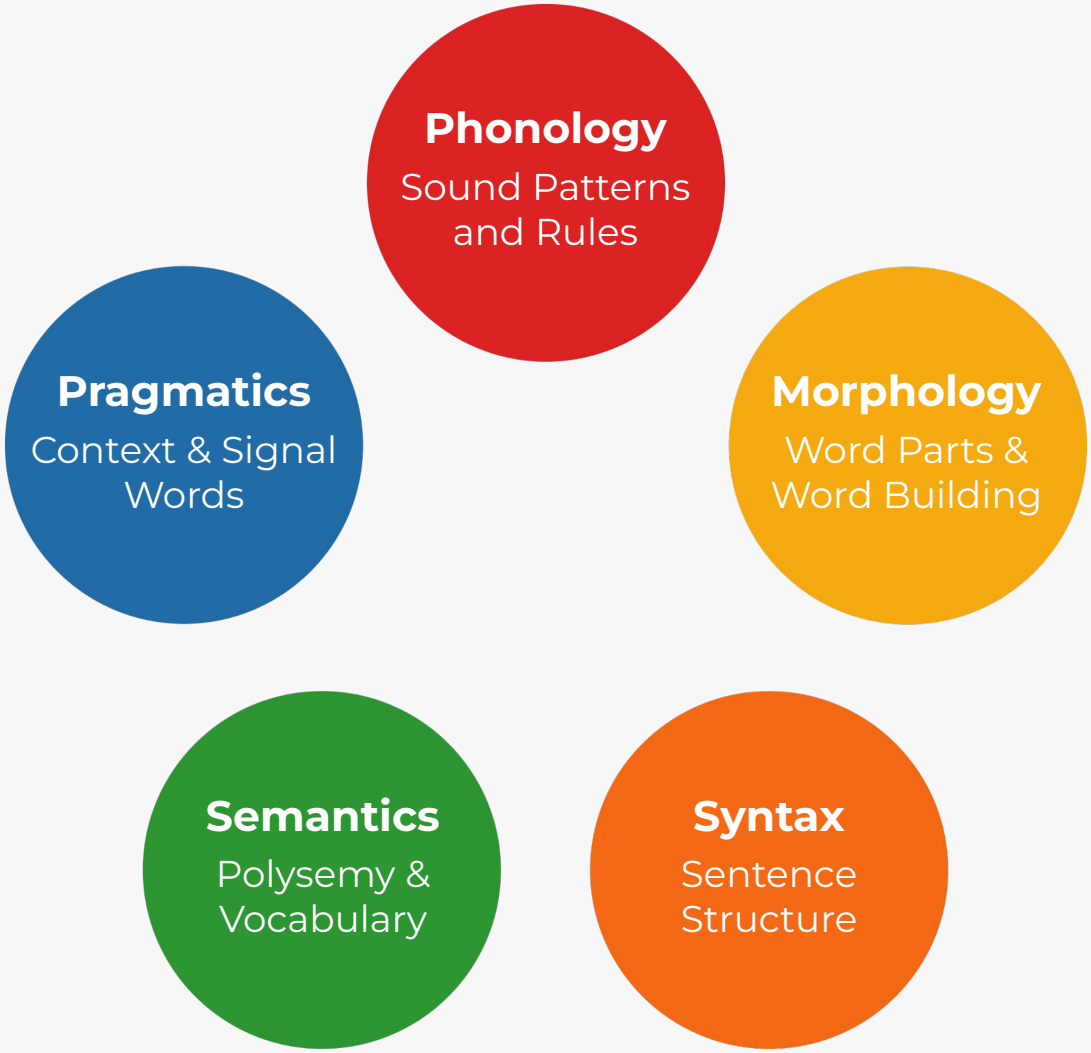
Units of Study Overview and Teacher Guides

Implementation Guide for a 45 minute Schedule

ThinkCERCA™

READING FOUNDATIONS:

A Linguistics Approach



Why Secondary Foundational Literacy?

1. 7 out of 10 eighth graders read below proficiency (NAEP 2022)
2. Secondary teachers are trained in their content area and do not feel confident in supporting their struggling readers
3. There are few resources supporting secondary non-decoding students, which follow a science based reading approach.

PROGRAM OVERVIEW

- ThinkCERCA's platform provides a targeted assessment so that students are focusing on skills they lack and not skills they've mastered.
- Prior to each unit, teachers will have the opportunity to build their capacity as a reading expert by participating in professional development via video or slideshow so that they can feel confident enough to support their students.
- Prior to each lesson students will view a two minute artistically animated instructional video that explicitly and systematically explains the most crucial elements in reading.
- During each interactive lesson students will explore and exercise the most essential components of mastering literacy in the English language.
- At the end of each module students can engage with a high interest and accessible reading passage in order to apply the skills they are learning and increase their reading fluency.

Additional Platform Features

- Foundational Reading Curriculum for 6-12
- Assessment to target needed skills
- Various implementation models
- Animated instructional videos
- Personalized skills practice
- Background building reading passages

Services Overview

- Professional development for instructional leaders and teachers
- Support for implementing blended learning

Why Secondary Students May Struggle

- **Lack of Phonemic Awareness**: Difficulty in hearing, identifying, and manipulating individual sounds in words can impede reading development.

- **Weak Phonics Skills**: Inadequate knowledge of letter-sound correspondences and decoding strategies can lead to difficulties in accurately and fluently reading words.

- **Limited Vocabulary Knowledge:** Poor vocabulary skills can hinder comprehension and make it challenging for students to understand the meaning of words encountered in text.

- **Fluency Issues:** Slow or choppy reading, difficulty in reading with expression, and limited automaticity in word recognition can impact reading fluency and comprehension.

- **Weak Comprehension Strategies**: Ineffective use of comprehension strategies, such as summarizing, predicting, and monitoring comprehension, can lead to difficulties in understanding and interpreting text.

- **Lack of Engagement and Motivation:** Disinterest in reading, low motivation, and negative attitudes toward reading can contribute to reading difficulties and hinder overall reading achievement.

Body of Research and the Basis of Foundational Reading & Linguistics

RESEARCH CITATION:

R. Allington, “What Really Matters When Working with Struggling Readers,” The Reading Teacher 66, no. 7 (2013): 520–530.

Archer, A. and Hughes, C. (2011). Explicit Instruction: Effective and Efficient Teaching (New York: Guilford, 2011).

Eide, D. (2012). Uncovering the Logic of English: A Common-Sense Approach to Reading, Spelling, and Literacy. MN: Logic of English.

Hirsch, E. D. (2007). The knowledge deficit: Closing the shocking education gap for American children. Houghton Mifflin.

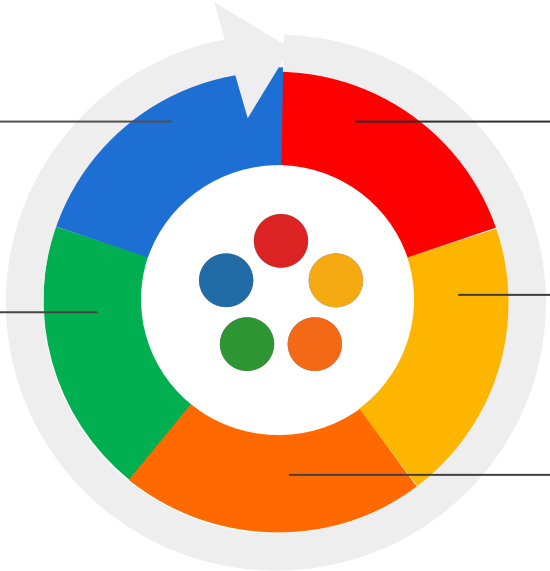
International Dyslexia Association, “Knowledge and Practice Standards for Teachers of Reading,” www.dyslexiaida.org/kps-for-teachers-of-reading.

Moats, L. C. (2020). Speech to print: Language essentials for teachers (3rd ed.). Paul H. Brookes Publishing Co.

Wexler, N. (2019). The Knowledge Gap: The hidden cause of America’s broken education system and how to fix it. New York, Avery, an imprint of Penguin Random House LLC.

How long does it take and where does it fit?

UNIT DESIGN



Fluency Practice (10 minutes)

Incorporate daily practice using fluency passages or other decodable readers.

Offline Reteaching (30+ minutes)

If students are struggling with a skill, pull a small group for a reteaching activity.

Pre-Assessment

Students complete a beginning of year assessment which will act as a baseline of their learning.

Video Lesson (< 3 minutes)

Introduce topic, skills, and other background knowledge.

Interactive Skills Instruction and Practice Lessons (20 minutes)

Direct Instruction and interactive practice and assessments on discrete reading skills.

FLEXIBLE TIER 1 2 or 3 IMPLEMENTATION MODELS

See Scheduling Options Here

Tier 2 Course	Semester Long Foundational Reading Course
Tier 1 Supplement	Personalized Learning Time in ELAR Course
Tier 2 Intervention Block	Personalized Learning Block Or What I Need (W.I.N.) Time in Any Course or Schedule

Foundational Reading & Linguistics

Implementation Options

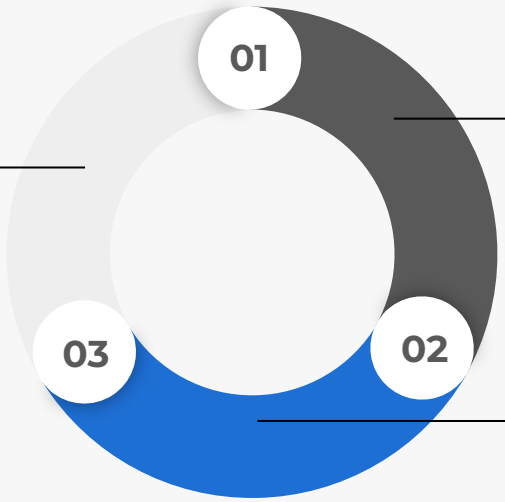
Tier 2 Semester Long Reading Course

SEMESTER LONG READING COURSE MODEL

Suggested Routines

- Assess and Assign
- Enable self-paced learning.
- Encourage choice reading when assigned lessons are complete.
- Use discussion strategies after readings.
- Conference with students to track growth and progress using our individualized student growth reports.

DAILY FLOW



(10 min) Daily Reading

Engaging readings provide practice in foundational reading while building knowledge and grade level comprehension skills.

Animated Instructional Video (3 min)

The artistically animated instructional videos present each concept in a highly engaging manner which prepare students for independent learning.

Daily Self-Paced Interactive Skills Instruction and Practice Lessons (15 min)

Student lessons are assigned as needed for self-paced instruction.

Embedded in a Tier 1 Blended Classroom

SUGGESTED ROUTINES

- Use personalized learning time to preview background knowledge, skills, and vocabulary for upcoming units.
- Encourage students to use self-help tools with on grade level materials (vocabulary, audio support, sentence stems, etc.).
- Enable self-paced learning of skills lessons and reading passages during W.I. N. time.
- Encourage choice reading when assigned lessons are complete.
- Use discussion strategies to enable students to engage with peers.

EMBEDDED IN TIER 1 CENTERS MODEL

- **A** — **Station A:** Vocabulary & Skills Development
- **B** — **Station B:** Overview & Connect
- **C** — **Station C:** Close Reading, Highlighting & Annotation, Summarizing
- **D** — **Station D:** Morphology Practice
- **E** — **Station E:** Editing & Personalized Learning
- **F** — **Station F:** Conferencing/Make Up/What I Need (W.I.N.) Time
- **H** — **Station H:** Choice of Longer Works

Weekly Progress Monitoring.

A Team Approach with Leveled Groups

SUGGESTED ROUTINES

- Use the Pre-Assessment to assess student needs
- Place students in groups based on achievement band and divide groups according to the owner of that group's growth.
- Schedule W.I.N. time in the school day so team members can work with their group
- Enable self-paced learning of skills lessons and reading passages during W.I.N. time.
- Encourage choice reading when assigned lessons are complete.
- Use discussion strategies to enable students to engage with peers.

What I Need Now Time Rotations

- A **Teacher A:** Group 1
- B **Teacher B:** Group 2
- C **Teacher C:** Group 3
- D **Teacher D:** Group 4
- E **Teacher E:** Group 5
- F **Teacher F:** Group 6
- H **Teacher H:** Group 7

Weekly team check-ins for progress monitoring and collaborative proactive problem-solving.

Foundational Reading & Linguistics

Pre-assessment Guidance

Measuring Growth through Pre-Assessments

ASSESSMENTS: (ON AVERAGE, 20 MINUTES PER PRE-ASSESSMENT)

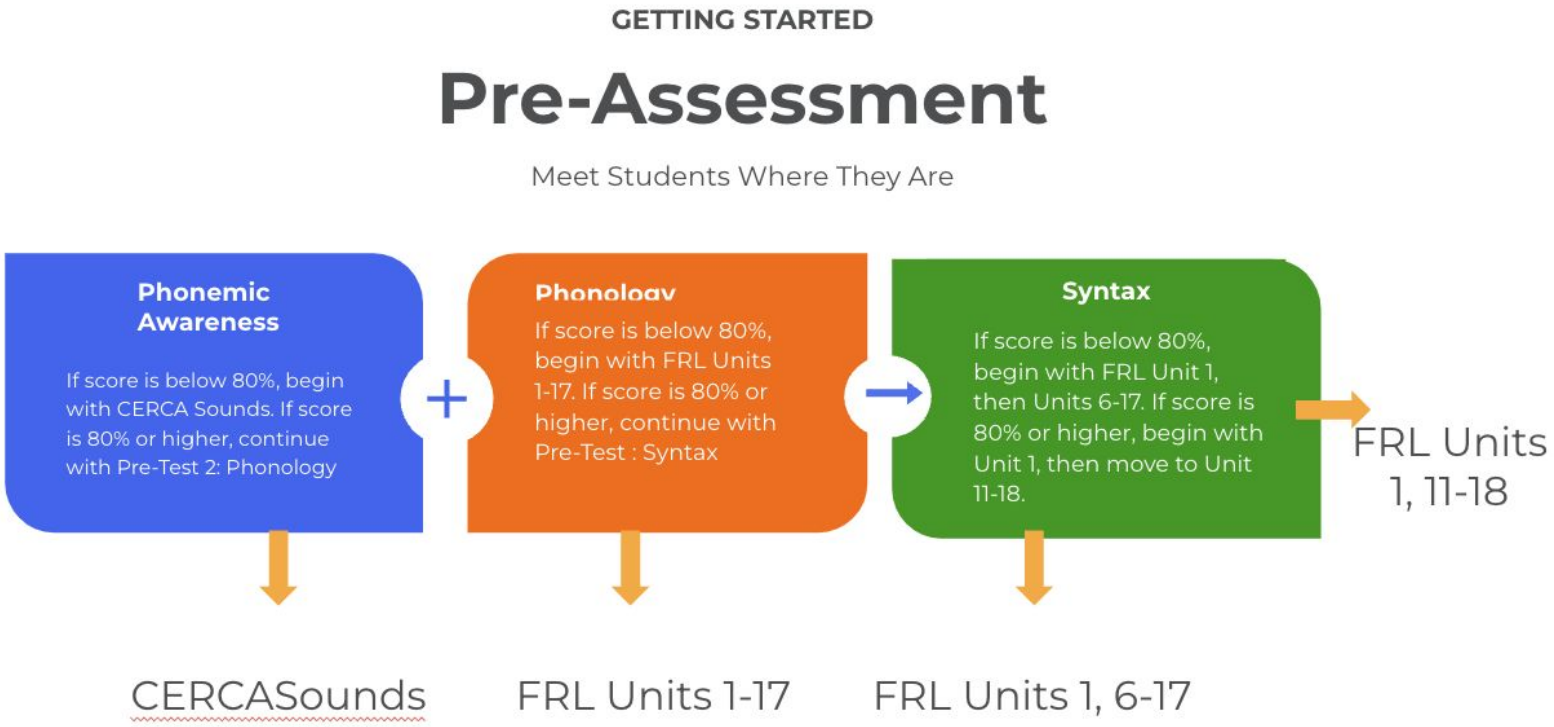
The Pre-assessment is made of three small assessments that will determine a student's entry point into the program.

Part 1: Phonemic Awareness

Part 2: Phonology

Part 3: Syntax

Upon completion of each section, students will be guided to an entry point into the program. They will begin with either CERCA Sounds Unit 2, 6, or 11. Students entering units 2, 6, or 11, should begin with unit 1.



Evolution of Language

Overview

Unit: Evolution of Language

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGES:** *Language Evolution*
Welcome	Navigating the platform	The Power of Language
Linguistics: The Study of Language	Language changes over time	About ChatGPT by ChatGPT
Expressive & Receptive Language	Verbal language precedes written language	Endangered Languages
The Evolution of Language	Ancient languages morph into current language	The Amazing Journey of Language
The Complexities of the English Language	English is a tricky language and here's why!	Complexities of English

Evolution of Language

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Language Changes **Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading**				
Session 1 45 minutes	**Session 2** 45 minutes	**Session 3** 45 minutes	**Session 4** 45 minutes	**Session 5** 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Lesson: ***Welcome*** navigate the platform. Students will complete a practice lesson learning how to navigate the space, practice, and quizzes all independently and low-risk. • Reading Practice: ***The Power of Language***	• Lesson: **Linguistics: The Study of Language** begins to build a framework of background knowledge so learners understand the relevance and importance of upcoming content. • Reading Practice: ***About ChatGPT by ChatGPT***	• Lesson: **Expressive & Receptive Language** examines the progression of learning speech to print. • Reading Practice: ***Endangered Languages***	• Lesson: **The Evolution of Language** helps students understand the advances of written languages from hieroglyphics to textspeech. • Reading Practice: ***The Amazing Journey of Language***	• Lesson: **The Complex English Language** define the many challenges of English from homophones, spelling exceptions, and word origins. • Reading Practice: ***Complexities of English*** • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Evolution of Language

What You Need to Know...

1. Linguistics is the study of language.
2. Expressive language refers to verbal language.
3. Receptive language refers to listening.
4. There are 26 letters in the alphabet, but those 26 letters can make a total of 44 sounds. For instance, the letter A makes three sounds like in the words: cat, cake, father.
5. There are more than 2 million words in the English language: the largest vocabulary in the world.
6. An average adult's vocabulary is around 50,000 words, while a well-educated adult has around 200,000 words in their lexicon.
7. The original English language is from a combination of Anglo-Saxon, Latin, and Greek, but many languages have been adopted into English. Cafe, ballet, restaurant and chef are all French words. Kindergarten and noodle are German words. The word typhoon comes from China and the word tornado comes from Spain.
8. Languages continue to change based on what's going on in the world. The invention of social media brought so many new words like selfie, hashtag, and emoji just to name a few. These words have only been in the dictionary for less than ten years!
9. Each language carries its own unique traditions, beliefs, and ways of expressing ideas. When we learn a new language, we're not only learning words, but we're also opening doors to different cultures.
10. There are many careers in linguistics from building Siri and Chat GPT to expanding businesses.

Potential Barriers

1. Higher level vocabulary. While students will encounter unique academic vocabulary, the introductory video and voice over supports will aid students throughout the lesson making grade level content accessible to any level of reader.
2. This unit is designed to introduce students to linguistics including the history of language, which can be a challenging topic for students. This marks one of the characteristic differences between this program and a typical foundational program designed for young learners.

Tips for ELL

1. **Embrace and Celebrate Cultural and Linguistic Diversity:**

   Create a classroom environment that values and respects the diverse backgrounds of ELLs.

   Incorporate culturally responsive teaching practices that recognize and honor students' unique traditions, beliefs, and ways of expressing ideas.

   Encourage students to share aspects of their language and culture, fostering a sense of belonging and appreciation.

   Scaffold Language Learning Through Visuals and Context:

   Use visual aids, graphic organizers, and real-life examples to support comprehension and vocabulary development.

   Provide contextualized learning experiences that connect language instruction to meaningful and relevant content.

   Incorporate gestures, body language, and visual cues to enhance understanding, particularly for students with limited receptive language skills.

2. **Promote Language Engagement and Interaction:**

   Create opportunities for students to actively engage in expressive language through speaking and writing activities.

   Encourage collaborative learning and pair ELLs with proficient English speakers for language support and practice.

   Foster a supportive classroom environment where students feel comfortable taking risks and using English, providing constructive feedback and encouragement.

UNIT 2

Foundations Alpha

Overview

Unit: Foundations Alpha

7 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGES:** *Unsolved Mysteries*
The Basics	Vowels, consonants, and the basics of language	Bigfoot: The Mysterious Creature of the Forest
Short and Long Vowels	Vowel identification and pronunciation	The Lost Colony of Roanoke
Initial C vs. K	When to use C vs. K	The Mysterious Loch Ness Monster
Consonant Blends	Pronunciation of consonant blends	The Lost City of Atlantis
Consonant Digraphs	Sh, ch, and th pronunciation	The Mysterious Dyatlov Pass Incident
The Qu Rule	Spelling and pronunciation of qu	The Mysterious Tale of D. B. Cooper
Y as a Vowel	The four different sounds of y	The Disappearance of Flight MH370

Foundations Alpha

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Vowels, c vs. k, blends and y as a vowel
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes	Session 6 45 minutes	Session 7 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM						
• Warm Up • Lesson: **The Basics** explicates the smaller components and foundational rules that inform word formation. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Short and Long Vowels** guides students through the pronunciation of different vowel sounds and the frequency in which they will find them. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Initial C vs. K** examines the situations in which C and K are used at the beginning of words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Consonant Blends** identifies where consonant blends appear and their correct pronunciation • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Consonant Digraphs** defines and examines the phonics of sh, ch, and th. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **The Qu Rule** defines and examines the use of qu. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Y as a Vowel** describes the consonant and three vowel sounds associated with y in relation to the placement of y within the word. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Alpha

What You Need to Know...

1. Prefixes are added to the beginning of root words and suffixes are added to the end of root words to change the meaning.
2. Vowels are in every word.
3. Short vowels are pronounced quickly and sharply while long vowels often say their own name.
4. If a word has a single vowel and ends in a consonant, the vowel sound is usually short.
5. When a word starts with a hard k sound, it is spelled with either the letter K or the letter C; if the second letter is a consonant or a, o, or u then the first letter is C; if the second letter is e or i then the first letter is K.
6. A consonant blend is a group of two or three letters where each letter keeps its own sound (examples: br, cl, st).
7. A consonant digraph is when two letters join together to make their own unique sound, thus dropping their own individual sounds (examples: ch, sh).
8. The letter Y makes a consonant sound at the beginning of a word or syllable; it makes the long i sound at the end of a one syllable word (fly); it makes a short i sound in the middle of a word (myth); it makes a long e sound at the end of a multiple syllable word (happy).

Potential Barriers

1. Students will be exposed to the terms *prefixes, roots,* and *suffixes* as a high level overview but more in-depth instruction on those topics will come later.
2. When learning about blends and digraphs, students may find it difficult to conceptualize letters keeping their sounds or making new ones; they can be encouraged to sound things out and use the audio feature for support.
3. Blends and digraphs are different but they both revolve around combinations of letters; There is a separate lesson for each concept to make the distinction more clear.
4. Students are exposed to letter sound symbols throughout the program, for example students will see /ā/ instead of “the long a sound”.

Tips for ELL

1. **Practice Decoding and Encoding Skills with Word Patterns:**

   Teach the rule that a single vowel followed by a consonant usually results in a short vowel sound.

   Explain the spelling patterns for words starting with a hard "k" sound, using the letter "C" or "K" based on the following letter(s).

   Introduce consonant blends and digraphs, highlighting their unique sounds and how they differ from individual letter sounds.

   Student Activity: Sound Sort

   Provide students with a set of word cards representing various short vowel and long vowel words. Instruct students to sort the cards into two groups based on the vowel sound. For an additional challenge, have them identify any consonant blends or digraphs in the words. Students can work individually or in pairs to discuss their sorting choices and share their findings with the class.

2. **Explore the Various Sounds of the Letter "Y":**

   Teach students the different sounds that the letter "Y" can make at the beginning, middle, and end of words.

   Provide examples of words that illustrate each sound and engage students in meaningful practice to reinforce their understanding.

   Student Activity: Word Hunt

   Assign students a word hunt activity where they search for words in books, magazines, or other texts that demonstrate the different sounds of the letter "Y." They can create a chart or record their findings in a notebook, categorizing the words based on the position of the letter "Y" and the corresponding sound it makes. Students can then share their word lists and discuss the patterns they observe.

   Remember to differentiate instruction based on students' language proficiency levels and provide ample opportunities for practice, reinforcement, and discussion. By incorporating hands-on activities and interactive tasks, you can actively engage English Language Learners in phonics and word analysis skills, promoting their language development and literacy skills.

Foundations Beta

Overview

Unit: Foundations Beta

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Oddities*
FLSZ Rule	Adding suffixes	What's Going on in the Bermuda Triangle
Word Endings: -dge, -ck, -tch	-ck, -tch, -dge endings	The Hungry World of Carnivorous Plants
Word Endings: -ng, -nk	Pronunciation and spelling	Aliens in the Desert
Magic E	Understanding E and its effect on vowel sounds	PT Barnum the Extraordinary Showman
Open and Closed Syllables	Syllable counting	The Wonder of Stonehenge

Foundations Beta

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: FLSZ rule, ng/nk, -ck, –tch, -dge endings, long & short vowels, open & closed syllables

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **FLSZ Rule** presents the rules for adding suffixes to single syllable words, specifically when to appropriately double the ending consonant. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Word Ending: -dge-ck, -tch** delineates the rules surrounding these word endings. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Word Ending: ng, nk** examines these consonant blend endings including pronunciation and spelling. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Magic E** details the use of -e and its effects on word pronunciations. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Open and Closed Syllables** systemizes the process of identifying one and two syllable words in relation to short and long vowels. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Beta

What You Need to Know...

1. The FLSZ hint helps students to know when the last letter of a word is doubled.
2. Usually, you double the last letter of words that have a short vowel sound and end in the letter F,L,S, or Z (example: buzz, bell, floss); there are exceptions so this is not a rule but a hint (exceptions: bus, was, has).
3. Digraphs (two or more letter groups that make one sound) generally make obvious sounds but there are some that are not obvious like ck /k/, tch /ch/, and dge /j/.
4. There aren't any English words that end in the letter j, instead the digraph dge makes the j sound (badge, ridge); the ck ending comes after a single vowel (block, trick); the tch ending comes after a single vowel with a short sound (stitch, catch).
5. A glued sound is when a vowel and consonants come together to make one sound, for example when you add a, i, o, or u to ng or nk they make a blended sound and form a word family (ink, sing, bank, long).
6. When the silent e (Magic e) comes at the end of a one syllable word, it makes the other vowel sound long (hope, slime); when it comes at the end of a multiple syllable word it makes the vowel closest to it have the long sound (admire, confuse).
7. A syllable is a beat or sound of a word; a closed syllable contains a short vowel sound followed by a consonant (cat, basket, wet, mitten); an open syllable ends with a vowel making the long sound (me, robot, hi, fever).

Potential Barriers

1. There are exceptions to many "rules", making them more like hints or generalizations; they are helpful to know because they apply to most situations but not all.
2. Some digraphs make a sound that is not obvious based on the individual letter sounds, for example dge makes the /j/ sound and tch makes the /ch/ sound; these are things students would have to learn because there isn't an obvious correlation to letter sound.
3. Students will learn the concept of glued sounds through the process of learning about the ng and nk endings.

Tips for ELL

1. **Introduce Phonics Rules and Patterns:**

   Teach students the FLSZ Rule hint as a useful tool to determine when to double the last letter of a word.

   Explain that words with a short vowel sound and ending in S, L, F, or Z often follow this pattern, but there are exceptions.

   Help students identify and apply other common phonics rules and patterns, such as digraphs and glued sounds.

   Student Activity: Doubling Letter Detective

   Provide students with a list of words that follow the FLSZ Rule hint pattern along with a few exception words. Have students work individually or in pairs to read and analyze the words, identifying which words follow the doubling rule and which ones are exceptions. Encourage students to discuss their findings and explain their reasoning.

2. **Practice Decoding and Encoding Skills with Digraphs:**

   Teach students about digraphs, which are letter combinations that make a single sound.

   Emphasize common digraphs such as ck, tch, and dge.

   Provide explicit instruction and practice opportunities for recognizing and producing the sounds associated with these digraphs.

   Student Activity: Digraph Sort

   Prepare a set of word cards that include examples of different digraphs, including ck, tch, and dge. Ask students to sort the cards into groups based on the specific digraph sound. For an additional challenge, encourage students to create sentences using words from each group to reinforce their understanding and application of digraph sounds.

3. **Explore Syllable Types:**

   Introduce the concept of syllables as beats or sounds within a word.

   Teach students about closed syllables (short vowel followed by a consonant) and open syllables (ends with a vowel making the long sound).

   Provide opportunities for students to identify and practice reading words with different syllable types.

   Student Activity: Syllable Sort and Build

   Give students a set of word cards representing words with closed and open syllables. Ask them to sort the words into two groups based on the syllable type. Then, have students use the word cards to build new words by combining closed and open syllables. Encourage them to read aloud the newly formed words and discuss the changes in pronunciation and meaning.

Long Vowel Sounds

Overview

Unit: Long Vowel Sounds

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Literary Monsters*
Long a Vowel Sounds: ai, ay, eigh, ey	ai, ay, eigh, ey pronunciations	The Birth and Evolution of Frankenstein
Long e Vowel Sounds: ea, ee, ey, ie/ei	ae, ee, ey, ie/ei pronunciations	Zombies: From the Grave to the Big Screen
Long i Vowel Sounds: ie, igh	Ie, igh pronunciations	The Legend of the Vampire
Long o Vowel Sounds: oe, oa, ow	oe, oa, ow pronunciations	Ghosts: Mysterious Spirits
Long u Vowel Sounds: ue, ui, ew	ue, ui, ew pronunciations	Werewolves: Mysterious Creatures of the Night

Long Vowel Sounds

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Long vowel pronunciations
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Long A Sounds: ai, ay, eigh, ey** navigates pronunciation skills in isolation and embedded in new vocabulary words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Long E Sounds: ea, ee, ey, ie/ei** navigates pronunciation skills in isolation and embedded in new vocabulary words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• **Long I Sounds: ie, igh** navigates pronunciation skills in isolation and embedded in new vocabulary words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• **Long O Sounds: oe, oa, ow** navigates pronunciation skills in isolation and embedded in new vocabulary words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• **Long U Sounds: ue, ui, ew** navigates pronunciation skills in isolation and embedded in new vocabulary words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Long Vowel Sounds

What You Need to Know...

1. The long a or /ā/ sound can be spelled: ai (paid), ay (say), eigh (sleigh), and ey (they).
2. The long e or /ē/ sound can be spelled: ee (bee), ea (beat), ey (key), and ie/ei (brief, ceiling).
3. The long i or /ī/ sound can be spelled: ie (pie) and igh (tight).
4. The long o or /ō/ sound can be spelled: oe (toe), oa (boat), and ow (row).
5. The long u or /ū/ sound can be spelled: ue (cue), ui (suit), and ew (few).
6. The long u is a two sound vowel, which makes the /yoo/ sound and the /oo/ sound.
7. Students will be exposed to the sound symbols (example: the long a sound is written in the lessons as /ā/ instead of "long a sound") but there are audio supports that students can use to help them decode the symbol.
8. Groups of letters that form vowel sounds are called vowel teams; in this unit we use the language "Long Vowel Sounds" instead of "Vowel Teams" since some vowel teams contain consonants. The use of the language "Vowel Teams" may be distracting to some students who would expect just vowels in the team.

Potential Barriers

1. The long sound for each vowel can be spelled in more than one way. This may be challenging for some students so ample practice is provided for each spelling.
2. Students will encounter the symbol for letter sounds throughout the program, for example long a is written as /ā/; the audio support will help students navigate the symbols.
3. The groups of letters that create the long vowel sound contain vowels and, in some cases, consonants as well. Conceptually this may be distracting for some students so we have chosen careful language wherein the description and instruction does not just refer to teams of vowels but rather letter groups.

Tips for ELL

1. **Explicitly Teach Long Vowel Sounds and Spelling Patterns:**

   Engage students in activities that helps them rehearse how to articulate the sound with their mouth as many of these sounds are not natural and/or part of their native language.

   Introduce students to the different ways long vowel sounds can be spelled.

   Provide explicit instruction on the spelling patterns for each long vowel sound, such as ai, ay, eigh, ey for the long /ā/ sound.

   Student Activity: Word Sort and Match

Tips for ELL

Prepare a set of word cards, each containing a word that exemplifies a specific long vowel sound and spelling pattern. Distribute the word cards to students and ask them to sort the cards based on the long vowel sound. Then, have students match each word card to a corresponding picture card. This activity reinforces students' recognition and association of long vowel sounds with their spelling patterns.

2. **Provide Visual and Audio Supports for Sound Symbols:**

   Introduce students to sound symbols as representations of specific phonemes.

   Ensure students understand the correlation between sound symbols and the corresponding long vowel sounds.

   Use visual aids, movement or gestures and audio supports, such as charts, a movement per vowel sound or online recording software, to help students decode and practice the sound symbols.

   Student Activity: Sound Symbol Match-Up

   Create a sound symbol chart or poster displaying the sound symbols for each long vowel sound. Give students individual cards with words containing long vowel sounds and ask them to match each word card to the corresponding sound symbol on the chart. Encourage students to say the words aloud and make connections between the sound symbols and the actual sounds they represent.

3. **Clarify Terminology: Long Vowel Sounds vs. Vowel Teams:**

   Explain to students that groups of letters that form vowel sounds are referred to as vowel teams.

   Acknowledge that the term "vowel teams" may be confusing for some students, as they might expect only vowels in a team.

   Use the language "Long Vowel Sounds" instead of "Vowel Teams" to avoid potential confusion and maintain clarity in instruction.

   Student Activity: Word Detective

   Provide students with a list of words containing long vowel sounds and ask them to identify and underline the spelling patterns for each long vowel sound. Have students discuss in small groups why the term "Long Vowel Sounds" is more appropriate than "Vowel Teams" for these patterns. Encourage students to share their findings and reasoning with the whole class.

UNIT 5

Foundations Gamma

Overview

Unit: Foundations Gamma

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Trailblazers*
Vowel Consonant/Vowel Words	vowel and consonant order in relation to syllable identification	George Washington Carver: The Plant Scientist
Vowel/ Consonant Vowel Words	vowel and consonant order in relation to syllable identification	A Golden Adventure: The California Gold Rush
Schwa	The schwa sound of differing vowels	Inspiring Nations
Soft c and g	The schwa sound of differing vowels	Junko Tabei: Conquering Mountains and Breaking Barriers
Vowel Consonant / Consonant Vowel Words	vowel and consonant order in relation to syllable identification	A Superhero with a Scalpel

Foundations Gamma

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Hard and soft C & G, schwa sounds, magic e, and QU
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Vowel Consonant / Vowel Words** defines vowel and consonant order in relation to syllable identification • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Vowel / Consonant Vowel Words** explains the combination of long vowels with a vowel-consonant blend in multiple syllable words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Schwa** describes which vowels and in which situations the schwa sound is used. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Soft c and g** works on listening, pronunciation and spelling skills associated with these consonants. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Vowel Consonant/ Consonant Vowel Words** teaches the strategy of mapping two syllable words with this vowel/.consonant combination. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Gamma

What You Need to Know...

1. VC/CV stands for vowel, consonant, consonant, vowel and is a syllable pattern found in two-syllable words (rabbit)that states that you divide the syllable between the two consonants.
2. V/CV stands for vowel, consonant, vowel and is a syllable pattern that states that the first syllable is always open and ends with a long vowel sound (tiger, human, robot) then it is followed by a consonant and a vowel in the next syllable.
3. Schwa is an unstressed vowel sound that sounds like the short u (banana) or short i (lemon) and is the most common vowel sound in the English language; all five vowels can make the schwa sound.
4. The letter c is soft and makes the s sound (/s/) when it is followed by the letters e, i, or y (center, cynic, city).
5. The letter g is soft and makes the j sound (/j/) when it is followed by the letters e, i, or y (gentle, giant, gym).
6. In the English language, the letter q is always followed by the letter u and together they make the /kw/ sound; the qu combination can come at the beginning of a word (queen) or in the middle of a word (squid).

Potential Barriers

1. Understanding syllable patterns may be a done through memorization, ample practice in the skill is provided to support understanding.
2. Schwa is the most common vowel sound in the English language but the most challenging to teach because all five vowels can make the sound; to help students understand the concept better there is ample practice provided in a dedicated lesson.
3. Students may be challenged by letter combinations that make sounds other than the letter sounds (for example qu makes the /kw/ sound); it may be helpful for students to utilize the audio feature to support their learning and hear the pronunciation.

Tips for ELL

1. **Teach Syllable Patterns and Syllable Division:**

   Introduce the VC/CV and V/CV syllable patterns to help students understand syllable division in two-syllable words. Use pictures that can help students remember syllable patterns such as a rabbit picture for the VC/CV pattern. These pictures act as Mnemonic devices in the ELL brain.

   Explain that VC/CV indicates dividing the syllable between the two consonants, such as in the word "rabbit."

   Highlight that V/CV indicates an open syllable with a long vowel sound in the first syllable, followed by a consonant and a vowel in the next syllable, as in "tiger" or "robot."

   Student Activity: Syllable Sorting

   Provide students with a list of words and ask them to sort them based on the VC/CV and V/CV syllable patterns. Students can create two columns or use sorting mats to categorize the words. Encourage students to identify the syllable division and the vowel sounds in each word as they sort them.

2. **Introduce the Schwa Sound and its Common Representations:**

   Explicitly expose students to different Schwa sounds by exposing them to listening comprehension activities- this strengthens their listening domain.

   Provide examples of words that contain the schwa sound, such as "banana" (short u sound) or "lemon" (short i sound). Use visual sorts of such sounds

   Provide ample opportunities to rehearse the sound of Schwa. Help students recognize and practice the schwa sound in different word contexts. This helps with their speaking domain proficiency.

   Student Activity: Schwa Hunt

   Instruct students to search for words that contain the schwa sound in various texts or classroom resources. Students can write down the words they find and highlight or underline the schwa sound representation. Encourage students to share their findings with the class and discuss the different vowel representations of the schwa sound.

3. **Teach Letter Sounds for Soft 'c', Soft 'g', and 'qu':**

   Explain the specific letter sound changes that occur with the letters 'c', 'g', and 'qu' in certain contexts. Use pictures as Mnemonic devices.

   Teach that 'c' makes the /s/ sound when followed by the letters e, i, or y, as in "center," "cynic," and "city."

   Teach that 'g' makes the /j/ sound when followed by the letters e, i, or y, as in "gentle," "giant," and "gym."

   Explain that the 'qu' combination always makes the /kw/ sound, whether it appears at the beginning or in the middle of a word, as in "queen" or "squid."

   Student Activity: Sound Switch

   Provide students with a set of word cards containing words with soft 'c', soft 'g', and 'qu' combinations. Ask students to sort the cards based on the specific letter sounds. Then, have students switch the letter(s) in each word to create new words and identify the changes in pronunciation. Students can work in pairs to play this interactive word-building game.

Basic Morphology

Overview

Unit: Basic Morphology

4 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Taking Flight*
Prefixes	Word analysis and the use of un-, mis- and re-	The First Flight
Suffixes	Word analysis and the use of -ed, -ly and -s	Amelia the Aviator
Root Words	Identifying the core root of words and their meanings	The Tuskegee Airmen
Making Words Plural	Word analysis and the use of s, ies, and es	Weather and Balloons

Basic Morphology

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Morphology

Skills Focus: Prefixes, suffixes & roots **Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading**				
Session 1 45 minutes	**Session 2** 45 minutes	**Session 3** 45 minutes	**Session 4** 45 minutes	**Session 5** 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Prefixes** works on identifying prefixes along with the meanings of un-, mis- and re-. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Suffixes** defines the term and focuses on the instances of -ed, -ly and -s. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Root Words** identifies the core root of words and how to add prefixes or roots. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Making Words Plural** examines the uses of s, ies, and es to make words plural. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Basic Morphology

What You Need to Know...

1. Prefixes are a group of letters that attach to the beginning of a root word to change its meaning.
2. The prefix un means not; the prefix mis means wrong; the prefix re means again.
3. Suffixes are a group of letters that attach to the end of a root word to change its meaning.
4. The suffix ed makes a word past tense; the suffix ly explains how something was done; the suffix s makes a noun plural.
5. When a word ends in the letter y, if there is a consonant before the y then you change the y to an i before adding a suffix (happy > happily); if there is a vowel before the y then you leave the y before adding the suffix (play > playing).
6. Words are made plural by adding the ending s, es, or ies.
7. If a word ends in the letter s, z, x, ch, or sh then add es to make it plural; if a word ends in consonant plus y then change the y to an i and add ies to make it plural; all other combinations, including if a word ends in vowel plus y, just add an s to make it plural.

Potential Barriers

1. Students will be exposed to technical vocabulary with the words prefix, suffix, and roots but will learn function of each through the instructional slides.
2. Students will encounter some examples of prefixes and suffixes but there are many more that exist for them to discover on their own.
3. Conceptually students may be challenged by the idea of changing y to i before adding a suffix, they can be supported by simplifying the explanation to say that the y only changes to i if there is a consonant before the y; it requires two levels of understanding (knowledge of consonants and adding endings).
4. When students are learning about making words plural, they are learning both the concept of plural/more than one and the different plural endings, which can be complex.

Tips for ELL

1. **Explicitly Teach Prefixes and Suffixes:**

   Introduce the concept of prefixes as groups of letters added to the beginning of a root word to change its meaning. Explicitly help students make comparisons with their native language. Teach common prefixes such as un (not), mis (wrong), and re (again). Use clear visual representation for these (as opposites) to help them grasp meaning. Provide different text representations where students can find examples of these. Real world examples such as ads,commercials, posts, blogs, etc.

   Student Activity: Prefix and Suffix Match-Up

   Prepare a set of word cards containing root words, prefixes, and suffixes. Ask students to match the appropriate prefix or suffix to the corresponding root word. Encourage students to discuss and explain the changes in meaning that occur when the prefixes or suffixes are added.

2. **Teach Spelling Rules for Adding Suffixes to Words Ending in 'Y':**

   Explain the rule that when a word ends in the letter 'y' with a consonant before it, the 'y' changes to 'i' before adding a suffix. Provide ample opportunities for students to practice these in all 4 language domains: Interpretive (reading and listening) and Expressive (speaking and writing) Clarify that when a word ends in 'y' with a vowel before it, the 'y' remains before adding a suffix.

   Student Activity: Word Transformation Relay

   Divide students into teams. Provide each team with a set of base words that end in 'y' and a mix of suffix cards. In a relay format, students take turns selecting a base word card, reading it aloud, changing the 'y' to 'i' if necessary, and adding the corresponding suffix card to create a new word. The relay continues until all base words have been transformed. The team that finishes first with the correct word transformations wins.

3. **Explore Plural Forms of Nouns:**

   Provide ample opportunities for students to practice these in all 4 language domains: Interpretive (reading and listening) and Expressive (speaking and writing) Explain that for words ending in 's', 'z', 'x', 'ch', or 'sh', 'es' is added to make them plural. Clarify that for words ending in a consonant plus 'y', the 'y' is changed to 'i' and 'es' is added to make them plural. Emphasize that for all other combinations, including words ending in a vowel plus 'y', 's' is added to make them plural.

   Student Activity: Plural Hunt:

   Provide students with a list of singular nouns and ask them to identify the correct plural form based on the given rules. Students can work individually or in pairs to complete the activity. Encourage students to discuss their answers and reasoning, and have them share their findings with the class.

UNIT 7

Foundations Delta

Overview

Unit: Foundations Delta

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Our Wondrous World*
Change Rule for Words Ending in y	Identifying how to add suffixes to words ending in y	The Secrets of the Pyramids
Doubling Rule: Adding -ed and -ing	Spelling with -ing and -ed endings	Nature's Masterpiece
Drop Rule : Silent E	Spelling, pronunciation	The Great Wall of China
R-Controlled Syllable	Pronunciation and blends	The Iconic Niagara Falls
The Letters ti, ci, si make /sh/	Pronunciation	A Symbol of Love

Foundations Delta

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Doubling rules, ti/ci/si sounds, r-controlled sounds, and e drops
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Change Rule for Words Ending in y** guides students through the rule for adding suffixes to words ending in y. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Doubling Rule: Adding -ed and -ing** explains the 1-1-1 rule concerning when to double the consonant when adding a vowel suffix. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Drop Rule : Silent E** explores the rules for E and how it changes vowel sounds from long to short. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **R - Controlled Syllable** depicts R controlled syllables along with their pronunciation • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **The Letters ti, ci, si make /sh/** illustrates how each of these phonetic combinations are to be pronounced. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Delta

What You Need to Know...

1. When a word ends in the letter y, if the y is before a consonant then you change the y to i before adding a suffix. For example: happy + ly = happily.
2. When adding a suffix to a word that ends in y, if the letter before the y is a vowel, you keep the y when adding the suffix. For example: buy + ing = buying.
3. When a word ends in a vowel followed by a consonant you double the consonant before adding the suffix ed and ing. For example: chop = chopped, chopping; skip = skipped, skipping.
4. When a word ends in a silent e, you drop the e before adding a suffix that begins with a vowel. For example: bake = baking; time = timer; file = filed.
5. An r-controlled syllable has one vowel followed by the letter r; words with ar make the /ar/ sound (far); words with or make the /or/ sound (born); words with er, ir, and ur all make the /er/ sound (first, per, fur).
6. In the middle of a multi syllable word, the letters ti, ci, and si can make the /sh/ sound (action, special, vision).

Potential Barriers

1. Students will practice their memorization skills when learning about adding a suffix to words that end in y.
2. Students will be called on to remember what they learned about consonants and vowels in previous lessons.
3. This unit will challenge students with the concept and rules surrounding dropping letters to add endings.
4. Letter combinations that do not sound the way they look are challenging for many students, the audio feature can be helpful here.

Tips for ELL

1. **Explicitly Teach Doubling Rules:**

   Introduce the concept of doubling consonants in certain situations to preserve the short vowel sound. Use everyday language words that students are familiar with when teaching this concept. Teach doubling rules such as doubling the final consonant when adding a suffix to a word with a short vowel sound and a single consonant (e.g., hop to hopping). Provide clear explanations and practice opportunities for students to understand and apply doubling rules.

   Student Activity: Doubling Rule Sort

   Prepare a set of word cards, each containing a base word and a suffix. Some words should follow the doubling rule, while others should not. Ask students to sort the word cards into two groups based on whether or not the doubling rule applies. Encourage students to explain their sorting choices and discuss the changes in pronunciation and spelling.

2. **Teach Ti/Ci/Si Sounds:**

   Introduce the specific sounds associated with the letter combinations 'ti', 'ci', and 'si'. Provide examples of words that contain these sounds, such as 'nation' for 'ti', 'cent' for 'ci', and 'fusion' for 'si'.Practice the pronunciation of words with ti/ci/si sounds and engage students in activities that reinforce their understanding of these sounds.

   Student Activity: Sound Scavenger Hunt

   Assign students a sound scavenger hunt activity where they search for words in books, magazines, or other texts that contain ti/ci/si sounds. Students can create a list of words they find and practice pronouncing them aloud. Encourage them to share their lists and discuss the different words they discovered.

3. **Explore R-Controlled Sounds and Dropping 'E':**

   Introduce the concept of r-controlled sounds, where the presence of the letter 'r' affects the pronunciation of certain vowels. Teach students words with r-controlled sounds, such as 'car', 'bird', 'fork', and 'torn'. Discuss the dropping of the silent 'e' when adding a suffix that begins with a vowel sound, and its impact on pronunciation.

   Student Activity: R-Controlled Word Sort

   Provide students with a set of word cards containing words with r-controlled sounds and words without r-controlled sounds. Ask students to sort the cards into the appropriate groups based on the presence or absence of r-controlled sounds. Students can read the words aloud and discuss the impact of the 'r' on vowel sounds in the words with r-controlled sounds.

UNIT 8

Foundations Epsilon

Overview

Unit: Foundations Epsilon

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *That's a Job?*
The ey Ending	Suffix endings	Unique Jobs: Flavorist, Pet Food Taster, Food Stylist, and Ice Cream Taster
Diphthongs	Vowels and pronunciation	Unique Jobs: Professional Sleeper, Cuddler, Professional Yawner, and Zen Garden Designer
The -k vs. -ck Rule	Spelling and reading	Unique Jobs: Professional Merperson, Waterslide Tester, Aquatic Stunt Performer, and Underwater Archeologist
Spelling aught and ought	Word recognition and meaning	Unique Jobs: Entomologist, Turf Scientist, Golf Course Designer, and Sod Farmer
Spelling -augh, -eigh, -igh, and -ough	Pronunciation	Unique Jobs: Ferris Wheel Operator, Air Traffic Controller, Zamboni Driver, and Gondolier

Foundations Epsilon

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Morphology

Skills Focus: Vowel teams, introduction to diphthongs, ck / k, -ey endings, and spelling patterns

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **The ey Ending** explores the different sounds that accompany -ey in relation to its placement in a word. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Diphthongs** depicts the different vowels that require a blend of sounds. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **The -k vs. -ck Rule** delineates between the situations one uses -k vs. -ck in words depending on placements and the preceding letters. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Spelling: aught and ought** explains the different pronunciations of these two structures along with the words that hold each. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Spelling -augh, -eigh, -igh, and -ough** builds upon the previous lesson to expound students' understanding of pronunciation and spelling of relevant words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Epsilon

What You Need to Know...

1. The letters ey at the end of a word can make the long e or the long a sounds. For example: monkey, valley, grey, they.
2. A diphthong is a gliding vowel where the sound begins as one vowel sound and moves to another vowel sound. For example: ou and ow both make the /ow/ sound (round, cow); au and aw make the /aw/ sound (auction, awful) and oy and oi make the /oi/ sound (boy, choice).
3. If a one syllable word ends with the /k/ sound immediately following a short vowel, the /k/ sound is spelled ck (thick, back, sock); use k after a consonant or vowel pair (oo, ,ee, ai) (park, walk, book); use ke when the letters come after a single vowel making the long sound (cake, bike).
4. The word endings ought and aught are used in past tense verbs (bought, thought, caught, taught).
5. The letter combinations igh make the long i sound (light); eigh makes the long a sound (weight); augh makes the /aw/ sound (caught); ough makes the long o and the /aw/ sounds (bought, though).

Potential Barriers

1. The English language continues to challenge with endings that are spelled one way but make different sounds; this is something that students will learn conceptually and then put into practice.
2. Conceptually, diphthongs are difficult to understand, examples are provided as they are both necessary and helpful.
3. Students will be introduced or reintroduced to the concept of Old English, this will require students to tap into their background knowledge.
4. It will challenge students when they are faced with letter combinations that do not sound like they look, the audio feature will be helpful here.

Tips for ELL

1. Navigate Vowel Patterns and Diphthongs:

Begin with an introduction to the concept of vowel patterns and how certain letter combinations create specific vowel sounds.

Teach about the versatile letter combination "ey" at the end of words that can create both the long e and long a sounds.

Introduce diphthongs as gliding vowel sounds that shift from one vowel sound to another and provide examples of common diphthongs.

Student Activity: Vowel Pattern Sort

Prepare a list of words that contain the "ey" ending and other words with different vowel patterns. Have students categorize the words based on the vowel sounds they create. This activity reinforces their ability to identify and differentiate vowel patterns.

2. Master Spelling Rules for the /k/ Sound:

Begin by explaining spelling rules for the /k/ sound in one-syllable words.

Teach the rule for using "ck" immediately after a short vowel sound (e.g., thick, back).

Introduce when to use "k" after a consonant or vowel pair (oo, ee, ai) and "ke" after a single vowel making the long sound (e.g., park, bike, cake).

Student Activity: Spelling Rule Practice

Provide students with a set of words and sentences that follow different spelling rules for the /k/ sound. Have them identify the correct spelling pattern for each word and use it in a sentence. This activity reinforces their understanding of spelling rules in context.

3. Decode Word Endings and Letter Combinations:

Introduce the word endings "ought" and "aught" and their usage in past tense verbs.

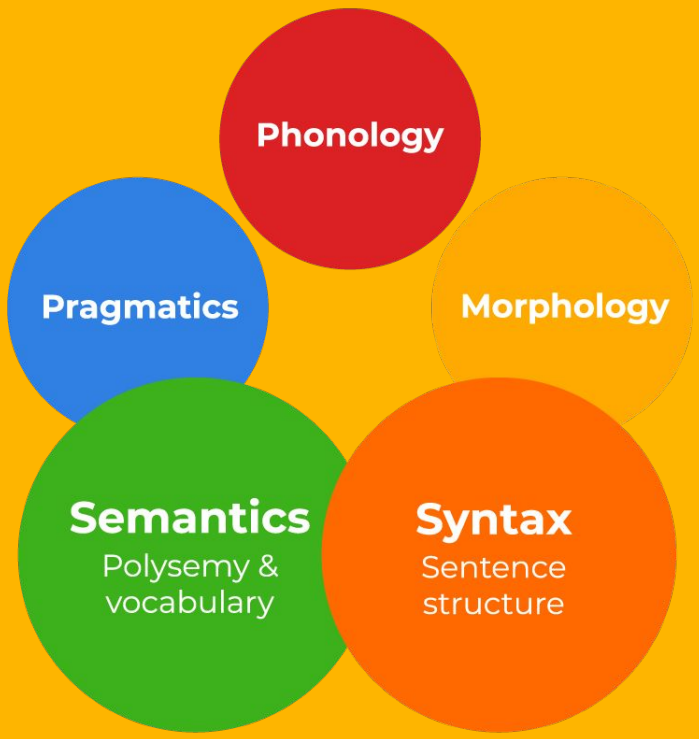
Teach about specific letter combinations such as "igh," "eigh," "augh," and "ough" and the corresponding vowel sounds they create.

Provide examples of words that contain these letter combinations to illustrate their usage.

Student Activity: Letter Combination Match-Up

Create a set of cards with word endings ("ought," "aught," "igh," "eigh," "augh," "ough") and words that contain these letter combinations. Ask students to match each word ending card with the correct word card. Encourage them to read the words aloud and discuss the sounds created by the letter combinations.

Exceptions to the Rule



Overview

Unit: Exceptions to the Rule

3 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Weird Science*
Contractions	Definitions, practice, and reasoning behind contractions	A Mysterious Connection
Homophones	Defining and identifying homophones	The Magic of Time
Commonly Misspelled Words	Exposure to spelling words that don't follow rules	The Signing Gorilla

Exceptions to the Rule

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skills: Semantics and Syntax

Skills Focus: Contractions, homophones, commonly misspelled words
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM		
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Contractions** examines why contractions, along with their alternate spelling, are helpful and the rules that guide their formation. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Homophones** defines this phonetic term while differentiating between their, there, they're, your, you're and to, too, and two. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Commonly Misspelled Words** identifies four causes of commonly misspelled words: ei/ie, double letters, difficult pronunciation and silent e. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Exceptions to the Rule

What You Need to Know...

1. Contractions are shortened forms of two words joined together.
2. When writing contractions, some letters are deleted and replaced by an apostrophe (do not = don't, are not + aren't).
3. Homophones are two or more words that sound the same but have different spelling and different meaning (examples: two, to, too; they're, their, there).
4. English is a challenging language to learn due to all of the exceptions. Generally there are rules that help students learn most of the conventions but part of learning the language is learning that exceptions exist and some words are learned by exposure rather than by applying a rule.
5. Commonly misspelled words are those with a silent e ending (minute, because); words that don't sound the way they look (island); words with double letters (address, vacuum).

Potential Barriers

1. Students may be challenged by the new pronunciation of contractions but can be supported by the audio feature on each slide.
2. The definition of homophones may be conceptually accessible for learning but the examples are plentiful, more than one lesson can support. While this lesson provides an introduction, additional examples may be warranted.
3. The complexity of the English language shows us that, though rules can help to know how to spell or pronounce many words, many of those rules have exceptions and some words will just have to be learned by exposure.

Tips for ELL

1. **Navigate Contractions and Homophones:**

Introduce contractions as shortened forms of two words combined with an apostrophe.

Explain the process of deleting certain letters when forming contractions (e.g., do not = don't).

Teach about homophones, which are words that sound the same but have different spellings and meanings.

Student Activity: Contraction Match-Up

Provide students with a list of contractions and their expanded forms. Have them match each contraction with the corresponding full phrase. This activity reinforces their understanding of contractions and their meanings.

2. **Embrace the Complexity of English:**

Discuss the complexities of the English language and the presence of exceptions to rules.

Explain that while there are rules that help with conventions, some words are learned through exposure.

Encourage students to embrace the learning process and understand that exceptions are part of language development.

Student Activity: Exception Exploration

Present students with sentences containing both regular and irregular spellings or grammar patterns. Have them identify and discuss the exceptions within these sentences. This activity helps students recognize the diversity within the English language.

3. **Tackle Commonly Misspelled Words:**

Discuss commonly misspelled words, including those with silent "e" endings and words that have unexpected pronunciations.

Explain the challenge of words with double letters and how they might not sound as they are spelled.

Student Activity: Misspelled Word Challenge

Compile a list of commonly misspelled words and their correct spellings. Provide sentences with the misspelled versions and ask students to identify and correct the errors. This activity helps students practice correct spellings and reinforces the concept of challenging words.

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UNIT 10

Foundations Zeta

Overview

Unit: Foundations Zeta

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Treasure Hunting*
Syllable Knowledge Application	Syllable patterns	The Hidden Treasure of the Knights Templar
Spelling with -ch vs. tch and dg vs. dge	Pronunciation and vocabulary	Exploring the Oak Island Money Pit
Vowel / Vowel Syllable Division	Syllable division patterns	The Lost Dutchman's Gold Mine
The Sounds ie and ei Make Together	Long vowel sounds	The Lost City of El Dorado
Consonant -le	Nine letters that attach to -Le	The Beale Ciphers

Foundations Zeta

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Phonology

Skills Focus: Contractions, homophones, commonly misspelled words
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Syllable Knowledge Application** gives further instruction in counting syllables, especially with prefixes and suffixes. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Spelling with ch vs. tch and dg vs. dge** depicts these letter combinations in various situations to practice the consonant blends. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Vowel / Vowel Syllable Division** contrasts vowel teams and vowel/vowel syllable divisions. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **The Sounds ie and ei Make Together** explorers the /ē/, /ī/, and /ā/ pronunciations of these vowel teams. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Consonant -le** expounds upon spelling rules associated with -le with special focus on the 9 letters with which -le combines. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Zeta

What you need to know...

1. Syllables are words or parts of words with one vowel sound; to find the number of syllables you can count the vowel sounds; prefixes and suffixes each count as one syllable.
2. Long vowel sounds and consonants give the /ch/ sound the ch spelling (reach, church); the short vowel sounds give the /ch/ sound the tch spelling (ditch); long vowel sounds and consonants give the /j/ sound the ge spelling (huge, large); short vowel sounds give the /j/ sound the dge spelling (judge).
3. V/V is a syllable division pattern that splits apart two vowels in a multisyllable word; vowel teams that combine to make one sound cannot be divided (keep) but two vowels together that make separate sounds can be divided (cooperate).
4. The letter combination ie can make the long e sound like in the word believe or the long i sound like in the word pie; the combination ei can make the long e sound if the letters come after a c (ceiling) or the long a sound like in the word vein.
5. The consonant + le syllable makes the /uhl/ sound (purple) and is considered a stable syllable that is always found at the end of a word; the consonants that come before the le are: b, c, d, f, g, k, p, st, t, z.

Potential Barriers

1. It will challenge students when they are faced with letter combinations that do not sound like they look, the audio feature will be helpful here.
2. Students will need to tap into their knowledge of vowel teams to successfully be able to divide v/v syllables.
3. The ie/ei rule has many exceptions, thus making it more of a guideline than rule however, the guidelines in this unit covers most scenarios, the exceptions are words that students would memorize usually as they learn them organically.

Tips for ELL

1. **Master Syllable Structure:**

Explain that syllables are units of speech with one vowel sound.

Teach students to count vowel sounds to determine the number of syllables in a word.

Clarify that prefixes and suffixes are each counted as one syllable.

Student Activity: Syllable Sort

Provide a list of words and ask students to identify the number of syllables in each word. Have them categorize the words based on the syllable count. This interactive activity enhances students' understanding of syllable structure.

2. **Decode /ch/ and /j/ Sounds:**

Teach the spelling patterns for the /ch/ and /j/ sounds.

Explain that long vowel sounds and consonants often lead to the /ch/ sound spelled as "ch" (reach, church).

Illustrate that short vowel sounds lead to the /ch/ sound spelled as "tch" (ditch).

Student Activity: Sound-Spelling Match

Provide students with a list of words containing the /ch/ and /j/ sounds. Have them categorize the words based on the spelling pattern used for each sound. This hands-on activity reinforces the connection between sound and spelling.

3. **Explore Syllable Division Patterns:**

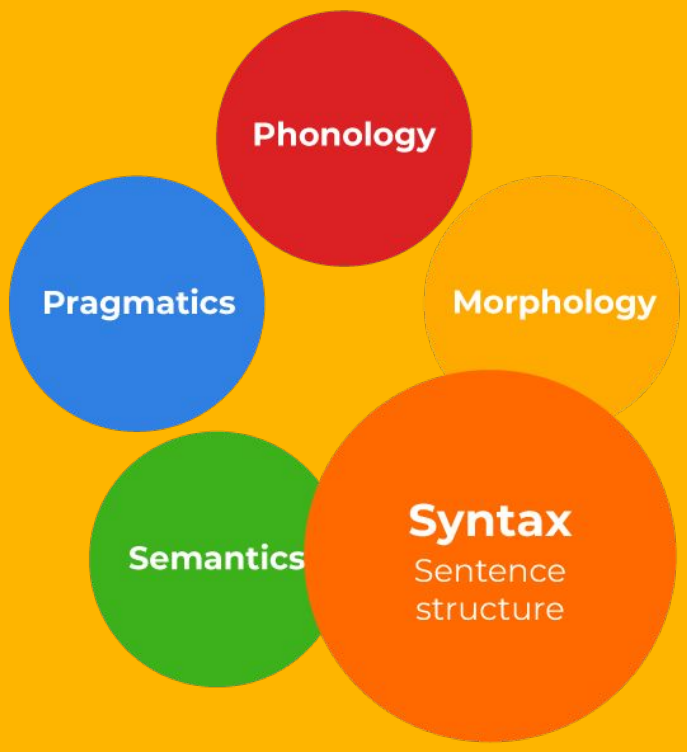
Teach the V/V syllable division pattern, which divides multisyllable words with two separate vowel sounds.

Illustrate that vowel teams that make a single sound (e.g., "ee" in "keep") stay together, while those that make separate sounds (e.g., "oa" in "cooperate") can be divided.

Student Activity: Syllable Division Hunt

Provide students with a list of multisyllabic words. Have them identify words that follow the V/V syllable division pattern and those that contain vowel teams that can be divided. This activity promotes students' awareness of syllable division rules.

Foundations Eta



Overview

Unit: Foundations Eta

4 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Extreme Sports*
Parts of Speech 1	Identifying noun, verb, adverb, and adjective	Extreme Sports: Ice Climbing, Snowboarding, and Freeskiing
Parts of Speech 2	Identifying pronoun, preposition, conjunction, interjection	Extreme Sports: Wingsuit Flying, Base Jumping, and Rock Climbing
Subject and Predicate	Combining subjects and predicates	Extreme Sports: Motocross, Street Luge, and Off-road Racing
Subject Verb Agreement	Combining subjects and verbs	Extreme Sports: Skydiving, Paragliding, and Bungee Jumping

Foundations Eta

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Syntax

Skills Focus: Nouns, verbs, adverbs, adjectives, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions and interjections

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	**Session 2** 45 minutes	**Session 3** 45 minutes	**Session 4** 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM			
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Parts of Speech 1** differentiates between nouns, verbs, adverbs, and adjectives. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Parts of Speech 2** differentiates between pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, and interjections • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Subject and Predicate** details the difference between sentence subjects and predicates. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Subject Verb Agreement** examines the how and why of sentence, verb agreement. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Foundations Eta

What You Need to Know...

1. A noun is a person, place, or thing (man, city, building).
2. An adjective describes a noun (old, busy, shiny).
3. A verb is an action word (walk, talk, laugh).
4. An adverb describes a verb (quickly, loudly, hurried).
5. Pronouns take the place of nouns (I, we, they, she, him).
6. Prepositions are words that come before a noun or pronoun to show direction, location, time, or place (below, after, on).
7. Conjunctions are words that join parts of a sentence together (and, but).
8. Interjections are words that show feelings, requests, or demands (hurray, ouch).
9. The complete subject is the part of the sentence that shows what the sentence is about; the simple subject is the noun or pronoun in the complete subject.
10. The complete predicate is the part of the sentence that tells what the subject is doing; the simple predicate is the verb in the complete predicate.
11. Sentence : My puppy chews on my shoes. Complete subject = My puppy; simple subject = puppy; complete predicate = chews on my shoes; simple predicate = chews.
12. Subjects and verbs must agree in a sentence; if a subject is singular then the verb is singular, if the subject is plural then the verb is plural.

Potential Barriers

1. Parts of speech require memorization of definitions, which may be challenging for some students; using examples can support that process.
2. Differentiating between simple and complex subjects and predicates may require additional practice.
3. When connecting singular verbs and subjects, it can be confusing to say that singular verbs can end in s or es in order to match the singular subject. S and es endings typically indicate plural except in this case.

Tips for ELL

1. **Scaffold Understanding of Sentence Structure and Parts of Speech:**

   Begin with clear definitions of nouns, adjectives, verbs, adverbs, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, and interjections. Use visuals and real-life examples to help students grasp the meanings and functions of each part of speech. Provide sentence examples that incorporate different parts of speech and highlight their roles within sentences.

   Student Activity: Sentence Parts Sort

   Prepare a set of sentence cards, each containing a sentence with highlighted parts of speech. Ask students to read the sentences and identify the parts of speech in each. Then, have them categorize the sentence cards based on the highlighted parts of speech. This activity reinforces students' understanding of sentence structure and the roles of different parts of speech.

2. **Emphasize Subject-Verb Agreement:**

   Explain the importance of subject-verb agreement in constructing grammatically correct sentences. Teach students that a singular subject requires a singular verb, and a plural subject requires a plural verb. Provide practice exercises where students identify the subject and the corresponding verb in sentences.

   Student Activity: Subject-Verb Match-Up

   Create sentence pairs with subjects and verbs that match in number. Mix up the subjects and verbs and distribute them to students. Have students work in pairs to match the correct subject with its corresponding verb to create grammatically accurate sentences. Encourage students to share their completed sentence pairs with the class.

3. **Break Down Sentence Components:**

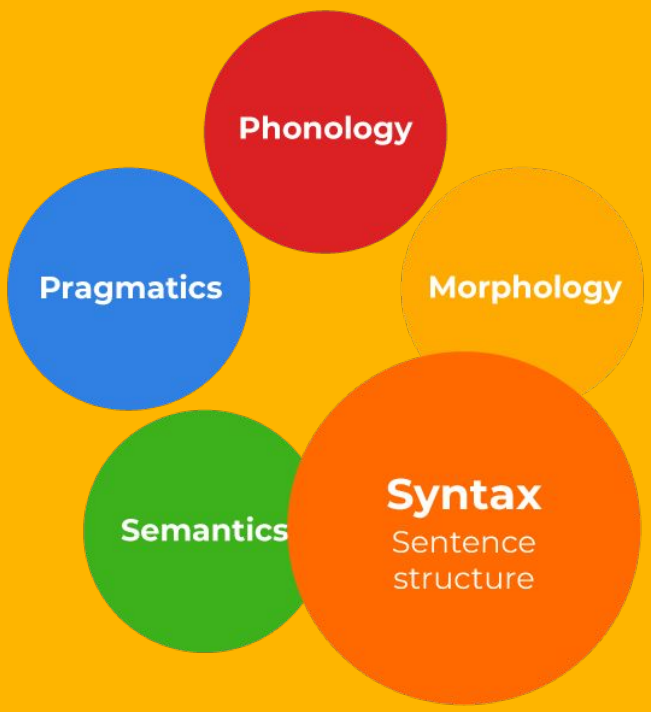
   Introduce the concepts of complete subjects, simple subjects, complete predicates, and simple predicates. Illustrate how these components work together to form sentences. Provide sentence examples and guide students in identifying and analyzing the different sentence components.

   Student Activity: Sentence Component Analysis

   Display a sentence on the board and guide students through the process of identifying the complete subject, simple subject, complete predicate, and simple predicate. Encourage students to work in pairs to analyze additional sentences and break down their components. This activity helps students gain a deeper understanding of how sentences are structured.

UNIT 12

Sentence Building



Overview

Unit: Sentence Building

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Street Artists*
Simple Sentences	Sentence Structure	The Amazing Art of Shepard Fairey
Building Compound Sentences	Clauses, conjunctions and punctuation	The Brooklyn Artist: Basquiat
Complex Sentences	Clauses, conjunctions and punctuation	The One & Only Banksy
Sentence Building	The formula of a sentence	The Colorful Street Artists
How to Read Primary Source Documents	Primary sources and cursive writing	Swoon the Storyteller

Sentence Building

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Syntax

Skills Focus: Subject verb agreement, sentence types, and sentence & paragraph building

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Simple Sentence** expounds upon the bare essentials and structure of a simple sentence. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Building Compound Sentences** focuses on the three needed components of such sentences (independent clauses, coordinating conjunctions and a comma) and how to combine them. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Complex Sentences** introduces dependent clauses and the process of conjoining them to independent clauses. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Sentence Building** reviews simple sentences and clauses followed by guidance in how to combine them in sentence formation. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Paragraphing** emphasizes the organization of a paragraph, highlighting the role of topic sentences and supporting details. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Sentence Building

What You Need to Know...

1. A sentence expresses a complete thought.
2. A simple sentence contains a subject and a verb and express only one thought (I (s) danced (v) in the show.). The subject and verb can sometimes be compound or more than one subject and verb (Janet and Jessica (cs) like to dance. They will dance and sing (cv) in the show.).
3. Simple sentences can be declarative (statement ending in a period), interrogative (question ending in a question mark), imperative (command ending in a period or exclamation point), and exclamative (exclamation ending in an exclamation point).
4. Dependent clauses cannot stand alone (Because it rained; While we were at the store); an independent clause is a complete thought, it is a simple sentence that makes sense on its own (My favorite candy is peanut butter cups.).
5. Subordinating conjunctions connect dependent clauses to independent clauses (Examples: because, so , since, due to, as).
6. Complex sentences have three components: a dependent clause, an independent clause, and a subordinating conjunction.
7. A compound sentence connects two independent clauses with a coordinating conjunction (and, but); there is a comma before the coordinating conjunction.
8. Every paragraph has a main idea, which states what the paragraph is about; the topic sentence starts a paragraph and contains the main idea; supporting details give additional information about the main idea.

Potential Barriers

1. Students will require background knowledge about parts of speech for this unit.
2. Understanding subordinating conjunctions requires a higher level of skill as students will first need to know what dependent and independent clauses are; some words that can be subordinate clauses (because) are only a subordinate clause is they come between the dependent and independent clauses - not if they start a sentence.
3. To understand complex and compound sentence structure, students need the background knowledge about clauses.

Tips for ELL

1. **Break Down Sentence Types and Structures:**

- Begin by explaining the concept of a complete thought as the foundation of a sentence.
- Teach the characteristics of a simple sentence, including its subject and verb, and how these can be compound.
- Introduce the different sentence types: declarative, interrogative, imperative, and exclamative.

Student Activity: Sentence Type Sort

Provide students with sentence cards representing each type (declarative, interrogative, imperative, exclamative). Ask them to read each sentence and categorize it based on its type. Encourage students to identify the sentence's structure and ending punctuation, enhancing their comprehension of sentence variety.

2. **Teach Independent and Dependent Clauses:**

- Differentiate between independent and dependent clauses, emphasizing that independent clauses can stand alone, while dependent clauses cannot.
- Introduce subordinating conjunctions and their role in connecting dependent clauses to independent clauses.
- Show students how to form complex sentences by combining an independent clause, a dependent clause, and a subordinating conjunction.

Student Activity: Building Complex Sentences

Provide students with independent and dependent clause cards, as well as subordinating conjunction cards. Have them work in pairs to create complex sentences by selecting an independent clause, a dependent clause, and a subordinating conjunction. Encourage students to read their sentences aloud and discuss how the clauses and conjunctions work together.

3. **Understand Main Idea and Paragraph Structure:**

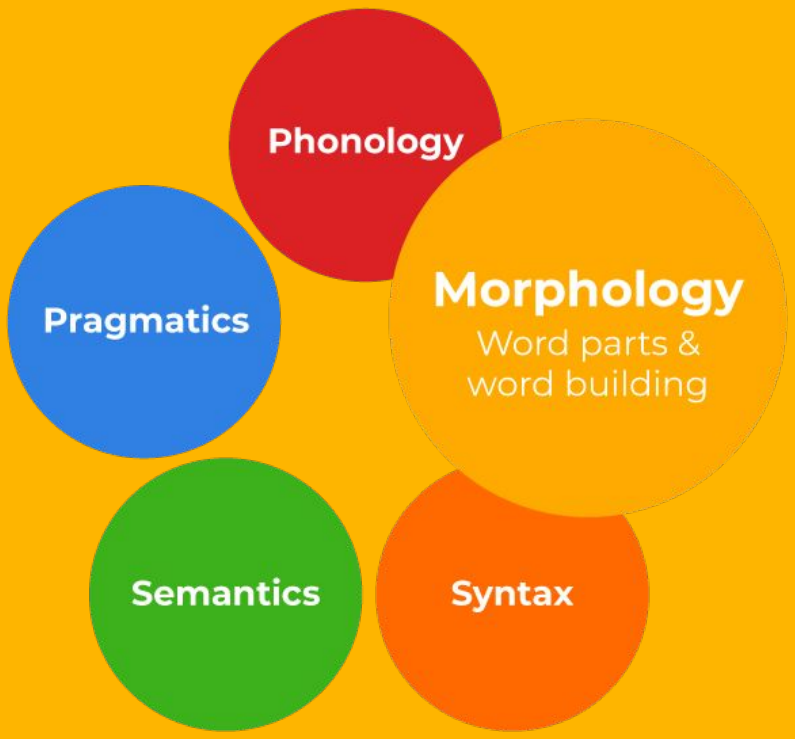
- Explain the concept of a main idea in a paragraph as the central focus of the content.
- Teach students that a paragraph starts with a topic sentence containing the main idea, followed by supporting details that provide additional information.
- Discuss how paragraphs are organized to present information coherently and logically.

Student Activity: Paragraph Analysis

Provide students with a short paragraph and ask them to identify the topic sentence (main idea) and the supporting details. Encourage them to discuss the relationship between the topic sentence and the details and explain how they contribute to the paragraph's overall meaning.

UNIT 13

Ancient Roots to Modern Spelling



Overview

Unit: Ancient Roots to Modern Spelling

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Golden Moments in Sports*
Word Origins	-Language evolution, spelling	The Legend of Roberto Clemente
Words with French Origin	Pronunciation of -age, -ture, -che, -our	The 1980 Miracle on Ice
Foreign Words and Quirky Spellings	Pronunciation of Greek, French, and Anglo-Saxon derived words	The Rumble in the Jungle
English Words Don't End in i, j, u, and v	Spelling rules	Usain Bolt : The Lightning speed Champion
Accent Marks	Introduction to acute, breve, macron and diaeresis accent marks	The Hand of God Goal

Ancient Roots to Modern Spelling

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Morphology

Skills Focus: French, Latin, Greek, Anglo-Saxon word origins and how it impacts spelling and meaning

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Word Origins** inspects the influences upon the english language that help in the reading and writing process. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Words with French Origin** expands the sphere of language influences to include French along with the various endings and letter combinations from each. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Foreign Words and Quirky Spellings** examines the influence of Greek, French and Anglo-Saxon words. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **English Words Don't End in i, j, u, and v** discusses how English words do not end in certain letters. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Accent Marks** introduces breve, acute, macron, and diaeresis accent marks. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Ancient Roots to Modern Spelling

What You Need to Know...

1. The English language was generated by combining influences from many other languages including Anglo-Saxon, French, Greek, and Latin.
2. English words with French origin include words that end in age /j/ like heritage; ture /cher/ like pasture; che /sh/ like quiche; our /or/ like contour.
3. English words with Greek origin that have a ch that makes the /k/ sound (chemistry) and that have a ph that makes the /f/ sound (photograph); words with Anglo-Saxon origin have a kn that makes the /n/ sound (knit).
4. In the English language, words do not end in the letters i, j, u, or v; the exceptions are the words I, you, and thou; there are combinations of letters that make these letter sounds but if a word ends in one of those letters then it is like from another language (or an abbreviation of a full word - taxi + taxicab).
5. A forward leaning acute accent mark (◌́) usually indicates a stressed syllable or raised pitch; a breve is a round or curved mark (˘) that usually sits above a vowel to indicate that it has a short sound; a macron is a flat mark (¯) that usually sits above a vowel to indicate that it has a long sound; a diaeresis is two dots (¨) that usually indicates that a letter is pronounced separately from the letter that came before it.

Potential Barriers

1. This unit will challenge students to think conceptually and have an understanding of the concept of word origins.
2. Students will be exposed to words in this unit that they may not see everyday, the audio feature may be helpful in learning the pronunciation of these words.
3. Students will learn the names of accent marks, which is not something they would hear or use in their everyday lives but is a meaningful thing to learn that may come in handy in the future and adds to their knowledge bank.

Tips for ELL

1. **Explore Language Origins:**

   Introduce the diverse origins of the English language, including influences from Anglo-Saxon, French, Greek, and Latin.

   Explain how these linguistic influences contribute to the richness and complexity of English vocabulary.

   Encourage students to discover the fascinating connections between English words and their origins.

   Student Activity: Word Origin Investigation

   Assign students a list of words with different linguistic origins. Have them research the meanings and origins of these words and create a visual representation (such as a word map or infographic) that highlights the connections between the word's origin and its meaning. This activity promotes vocabulary development and cultural understanding.

2. **Recognize Unique Language Patterns:**

   Explain specific language patterns in English words derived from different languages (e.g., French, Greek, Anglo-Saxon).

   Help students understand how certain letter combinations create distinct sounds and contribute to word meanings.

   Provide examples to showcase patterns such as phonetic shifts and spelling rules.

   Student Activity: Pattern Recognition Practice

   Share a list of words that demonstrate specific language patterns, such as French-origin words ending in "age," "ture," "che," and "our." Have students work individually or in pairs to categorize these words based on their patterns. This activity sharpens students' awareness of language structures and sound shifts.

3. **Decode Language Symbols:**

   Introduce diacritics (accent marks) used in English to indicate stress, vowel length, and pronunciation.

   Explain the purpose of diacritics, such as the acute accent, breve, macron, and diaeresis.

   Illustrate how these symbols aid in correct pronunciation and understanding of English words.

   Student Activity: Diacritic Exploration

   Provide a list of words with diacritics and their explanations. Encourage students to read these words aloud, emphasizing correct pronunciation based on the diacritic marks. Then, have them choose a few words to use in sentences, demonstrating their understanding of stress, vowel length, and pronunciation. This activity enhances pronunciation skills and phonetic awareness.

The Reading Brain

Overview

Unit: The Reading Brain

3 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *The Amazing Brain*
Processing Language	Learning strategies and decoding	The Curious Case of Phineas Gage
Learning Modalities	Knowledge of self and learning strategies	Brain Science : Look How Far We've Come
What is dyslexia?	Decoding skills	The Remarkable Kim Peek

The Reading Brain

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skills: Phonology, Morphology, Syntax, Semantics, Pragmatics

Skills Focus: Mental processes, learning modalities, dyslexia
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM		
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Processing** delineates the routes minds decode and process information as they pertain to language acquisition and information intake. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Learning Modalities** presents the four main types of processing and learning - auditory, visual, kinesthetic and tactile - along with practical implications for students. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Dyslexia** explains how dyslexia appears and how to navigate its challenges. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

The Reading Brain

What You Need to Know...

1. We use our eyes, ears, and brains to process written information.
2. We use our eyes to see the words; we use our ears to send the sound of the words to our brains (even when we are not actively reading aloud); the brain then combines what we see (letters) with what we hear (word sounds) to help us combine and process the information.
3. Learning modalities are the different ways that people use their senses to learn.
4. Visual modality is learning by seeing; Auditory modality is learning by listening; Kinesthetic modality is learning by action (dance, role play, physical activity); Tactile modality is learning by touch (building blocks, moving/manipulating objects, doodling while listening).
5. Dyslexia is a neurobiological difference that occurs in anyone regardless of intelligence or background where individuals struggle with matching letters to sounds; people with dyslexia can learn to read and write; many characteristics of dyslexia run in families.

Potential Barriers

1. Students will have to think outside the box for this unit, this is conceptual information.
2. When students learn about different modalities, we are asking them to use higher level thinking skills; students may be supported by using this as an opportunity to discover their own learning style.
3. Students can be reminded that dyslexia is not related to intelligence but rather a difference in the function of the brain and people with dyslexia can learn to read and write.

Tips for ELL

1. **Address diverse learning modalities**

Explain The concept of learning modalities:visual, auditory, kinesthetic, and tactile.

Emphasize that each person has their preferred way of learning.

Adapt your teaching strategies to accommodate different modalities to enhance understanding and engagement.

Student Activity: Modalities Exploration

Provide a variety of learning activities that cater to different modalities. For instance, offer a visual activity like analyzing an infographic, an auditory exercise like listening to a short story, a kinesthetic task like acting out a scene, and a tactile project involving building with blocks. Allow students to reflect on which modality they find most effective for different types of content.

2. **Introduce Dyslexia Awareness:**

Define dyslexia as a neurobiological difference affecting the ability to match letters with sounds.

Stress that dyslexia is unrelated to intelligence and can be managed.

Promote an inclusive environment where students with dyslexia feel supported and empowered to learn.

Student Activity: Dyslexia discussion and support

Organize a class discussion about dyslexia, its characteristics and how it may affect reading.

Encourage open dialogue with a Think-Pair-Share activity in a safe environment.

3. **Multisensory Learning Approach:**

Introduce the concept of multisensory learning, which involves engaging multiple senses for better retention.

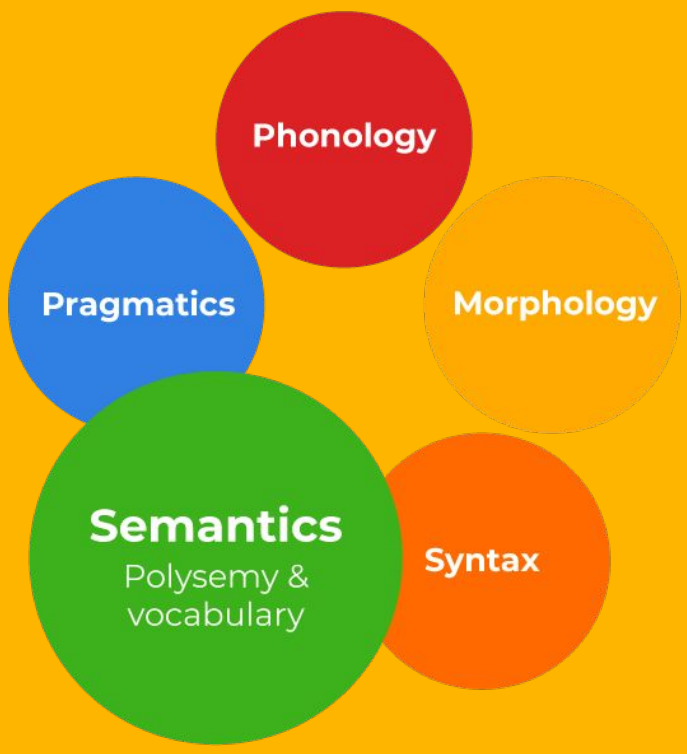
Emphasize that combining visual, auditory, kinesthetic, and tactile experiences can enhance understanding.

Incorporate activities that tap into different senses to enrich the learning process.

Student Activity: Multisensory Learning Stations

Set up learning stations where students rotate through different activities related to a specific topic. For example, a station could involve reading a short passage (visual), discussing it with a partner (auditory), acting out a scene from the passage (kinesthetic), and using tactile materials to create a representation (tactile). This approach reinforces learning through diverse senses.

Basic Semantics



Overview

Unit: Basic Semantics

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *When Nature Roared*
Multiple Meanings	Homonyms and decoding	The Toba Super-eruption
Shades of Meaning	Comprehension and semantics	The Chicxulub Asteroid
Figurative Language	Literary devices (similes, metaphors, etc.)	The Permian-Triassic Extinction
Idioms	Figurative language	The Great Oxygenation Event
Context Clues	Decoding and reading fluency	The Majestic Himalayas

Basic Semantics

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Semantics

Skills Focus: Figurative language and multiple meaning words
Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Multiple Meanings** examines homonyms that have the same spelling but different meanings, such as watch, ring, and right. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Shades of Meaning** explores how to use shades of meaning with verbs and adjectives and the advantage this practice gives the writer. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Figurative Language** teaches simile, metaphor and personification. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Idioms** utilizes the idea of figurative language to further instruct the ways of forming phrases that are non-literal. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage).	• Lesson: **Context Clues** reiterates where and what information readers gather that help decode passages' meaning. • Reading Practice (fluency passage, decodable readers, or Additional Reading Passage). • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Basic Semantics

What You Need to Know...

1. Homonyms are words that sound the same and are spelled the same but have different meanings (Examples: watch (tells time) and watch (to look at something); ring (jewelry) and ring (sound of a bell).
2. Context clues are the other words in the sentence as well as the sentence before or after a word that can help give students clues about the meaning of a word (I looked at my watch to find out what time it was - the word *time* gives us a clue about the correct meaning of *watch*.).
3. Shades of meaning is a phrase that refers to the subtle difference is similar words (big, large, gigantic / chilly, cold, freezing); word choice helps to make a writer's point or message more clear.
4. Figurative language is a method of using creative language to paint a picture in your mind.
5. A simile is a figure of speech that compares a shared trait of two unlike things using like or as (The flowers were as pretty as a picture; She is as fast as a cheetah.).
6. A metaphor is a figure of speech that compares a shared trait of two unlike things using but does not use like or as (He has a heart of gold; Time is a thief.).
7. Personification assigns human qualities to something nonhuman (The hot sun glared down at me, burning my shoulders with its wicked gaze; My car just gave up and quit on me.).
8. Idioms are a form of figurative language language where you cannot determine the meaning based on the individual words, it has to be read as a whole concept and context clues can help (Example: kill two birds with one stone).
9. Context clues can help students find the meaning of unfamiliar words; authors will use synonyms, antonyms, definitions, and examples as context clues.

Potential Barriers

1. Students will need to use context clues to find the meaning of a word that is a homonym.
2. This unit will challenge students understanding of the concept of meaning as it teaches students that words can have more than one meaning and that some words have similar meaning but can be used for different emphasis.
3. Similes and metaphors are very similar, with their main difference being the use of the words like or as (similes).
4. Idioms may be very challenging, especially for emergent readers and speakers of English as you cannot determine the meaning based on the individual words; it is a form of figurative language.

Tips for ELL

1. Navigate Homonyms, Context Clues, and Shades of Meaning:

   - Start by defining homonyms and explaining the concept of words with different meanings but the same sound and spelling.
   - Introduce the idea of context clues as surrounding words that provide hints about a word's meaning.
   - Teach about shades of meaning and how synonyms with varying degrees of intensity can convey similar concepts.

     Student Activity: Homonym Hunt

     Provide students with a list of homonyms and ask them to create sentences using each homonym to showcase its different meanings. Then, have students exchange sentences with a partner to determine the meanings based on the context. This activity enhances their understanding of homonyms and the role of context in meaning.

2. Embrace Figurative Language and Idioms:

   - Begin with a discussion on figurative language and how it adds depth and imagery to language.
   - Teach students the difference between similes (using like or as), metaphors (without like or as), and personification (assigning human qualities to nonhuman things).
   - Introduce idiomatic expressions as figurative language that relies on context for meaning.

     Student Activity: Figurative Language Exploration

     Select a short text containing examples of similes, metaphors, and personification. Have students identify and underline these figurative language elements. Afterward, discuss how each element contributes to the text's meaning and imagery. This activity allows students to identify and understand figurative language in context.

3. Master Context Clues for Word Understanding:

   - Explain the concept of context clues as words or phrases around an unfamiliar word that help determine its meaning.
   - Teach different types of context clues, such as synonyms, antonyms, definitions, and examples.
   - Emphasize the importance of using these clues to decode unfamiliar words and enhance comprehension.

     Student Activity: Context Clue Detective

     Provide students with sentences containing unfamiliar words and accompanying context clues. Have students work in pairs to identify the unfamiliar words and use the context clues to determine their meanings. Encourage them to explain their reasoning and share their findings with the class.

Textual Architecture

Overview

Unit: Textual Architecture

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Major Moments in Fashion*
Text Features: Charts, Graphs, Sidebars & Headings	Technical skills, navigating information	The Invention of Clothing
Paragraphing	Writing composition	The Rise of Street Style
Transitions	Fluidity in writing	The Life & Style of Coco Chanel
How to Read : Punctuation	Reading punctuation	The Journey of Renaissance Fashion
How to Read : Dictionary and Thesaurus	Using the dictionary and thesaurus	The Fabulous World of Runway Fashion

Textual Architecture

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Pragmatics

Skills Focus: Text features, transitions, author's craft and paragraphing

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **Text Features: Charts, Graphs, Sidebars & Headings** sharpens students' navigation and decoding skills of extraneous pieces in the text. • Practice passage: ***The Invention of Clothing***	• Lesson: **Paragraphing** formulaizes the basic components to a smooth, well-written paragraph. • Practice passage: ***The Rise of Street Style***	• Lesson: **Transitions** explores transition words for smooth writing. • Practice passage: ***The Life & Style or Coco Chanel***	• Lesson: **How to Read Punctuation** explains how punctuation aids in the reading and comprehension by indicating pauses, whole thoughts, etc. • Practice passage: ***The Journey of Renaissance Fashion***	• Lesson: **How to Read Dictionary and Thesaurus** explains the usage and features of the dictionary and thesaurus. • Practice passage: ***The Fabulous World of Runway Fashion*** • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Textual Architecture

What You Need to Know...

1. Text features are the parts of non-fiction texts that support the learning process (graphs, charts, sidebars).
2. Charts and graphs organize data, sidebars add additional information, and headings define and separate topics, subjects, or categories.
3. New paragraphs are required when you start a story/essay/paper, when you finish, when a new person starts talking, and when changing topics.
4. A transition is a word that connects ideas in writing; transitions words can show order of events (first, next), differing ideas (but, however), similar ideas (also, likewise).
5. Punctuation marks create the rhythm and flow of a piece of writing, they make the author's message more clear.

Potential Barriers

1. Text features are often overlooked in non-fiction texts but should be part of the learning process as they add significant support.
2. Transition words help to move text along but require some background knowledge of components of a paragraph.
3. Understanding paragraphing requires students to have understanding of main ideas, switching topics, beginnings and endings.

Tips for ELL

1. **Unlocking Text Features:**

Introduce the concept of text features as tools that enhance understanding in non-fiction texts.

Clearly explain the purpose of charts, graphs, sidebars, headings, and other visual elements in conveying information.

Show how these features help readers grasp key points, make connections, and find relevant details.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Textual Architecture

Tips for ELL

Student Activity: Text Feature Scavenger Hunt

Select a non-fiction text relevant to the students' interests or curriculum. Provide a list of text features such as graphs, charts, sidebars, and headings. Ask students to read the text and identify each text feature, discussing with a partner how it contributes to their understanding of the content. This activity cultivates active reading and comprehension skills.

2. **Crafting Coherent Writing:**

Emphasize the importance of clear organization in writing, including using paragraphs to separate ideas.

Teach students when to start new paragraphs: at the beginning and end of a text, with changes in speaker, and when transitioning to a new topic.

Show how paragraphs and transitions create a logical flow and help readers follow the writer's thoughts.

Student Activity: Paragraph and Transition Practice

Provide students with a short passage lacking proper paragraphs and transitions. Have them work individually or in pairs to identify points where new paragraphs should begin and where transitions are needed. Students can then revise the passage, adding appropriate paragraphs and transition words. This activity enhances students' writing coherence and organization skills.

3. **Mastering Punctuation for Clarity:**

Explain the role of punctuation in guiding readers through the text and conveying the writer's intended meaning.

Teach the functions of different punctuation marks, such as periods, commas, question marks, and exclamation points.

Illustrate how punctuation contributes to sentence rhythm, tone, and comprehension.

Student Activity: Punctuation Relay

Create a series of short sentences with missing punctuation. Divide the class into teams and assign each team a set of sentences. One student reads a sentence aloud to their team, and the team collaborates to determine the correct punctuation. The next student in line reads the revised sentence aloud. This activity reinforces punctuation rules and encourages teamwork.

Storytelling

Overview

Unit: Storytelling

5 Lessons		
TOPIC	**SKILLS**	**READING PASSAGE:** *Preserved in Time*
How to Read: Dialogue	Indicators of conversation within text	King Tut and the Mysterious Curse
Who's Telling the Story?	Recognizing first and third person narration	The Art of Mummification
Author Bias	Recognizing bias in text	Pompeii: Frozen in Time
Code Switching	Choosing between languages and styles to communicate	Time Capsules
How to Read: Dialect	Causation and influences impacting dialect	Crop Circles: Real or Hoax?

Storytelling

Tier 1 45-Minute Block Period

Linguistics Skill: Pragmatics

Skills Focus: Text features, transitions, author's craft and paragraphing

Lesson + Practice Application & Fluency Reading

Session 1 45 minutes	Session 2 45 minutes	Session 3 45 minutes	Session 4 45 minutes	Session 5 45 minutes
ONLINE PLATFORM				
• Warm Up • Lesson: **How to Read: Dialogue** introduces students to the mechanics behind dialogue in text. • Practice passage: ***King Tut and the Mysterious Curse***	• Lesson: **Who's Telling the Story** challenges students to listen to the voice of the writer in first and third person narrative. • Practice passage: ***The Art of Mummification***	• Lesson: **Author Bias** explores the impact of an author's opinions and beliefs on their writing. • Practice passage: ***Pompeii: Frozen in Time***	• Lesson: **Code Switching** discusses the transition between formal and informal speech in different settings as well as cultural impact on language choices. • Practice passage: ***Time Capsules***	• Lesson: **How to Read : Dialect** explains how authors create a more realistic character through the use of dialect. • Practice passage: ***Crop Circles: Real or Hoax?*** • Wrap Up

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Storytelling

What You Need to Know...

1. Dialogue allows the author to show what a character is experiencing through conversation with the use of quotation marks and identified by dialogue tags like the words said and asked.
2. Dialogue can reveal a character's personality.
3. A narrator of a story sets the stage by using a narrator's voice.
4. The two types of narrator's voice in this unit will be first person, character within the story and third person, someone outside of the story looking in and describing it to the reader.
5. One of the earliest book written in first person point of view was "Robinson Crusoe" published in 1719.
6. An Author's opinion can impact their writing which is known as Author's bias.
7. Author's bias can be expressed through word choices, tone and perspective which can result in changing a readers thinking.
8. The use of different language in different situation is known as code switching.
9. Code switching is choosing the language and style that is influenced by our people and community around us along with our cultural heritage and personal identity.
10. English is spoken different throughout the United States of America, dialect is a variation of the way we speak the same language which is developed from where people more and live.
11. Dialects are differentiated by the way words are pronounced and the use of vocabulary.
12. The use of dialect is used by authors to make characters more realistic.

Potential Barriers

1. Students who have not mastered the basic semantics, the introductory video and voice over support will allow the student to experience the skills without reading frustration.
2. Students will have to tap into their background knowledge and awareness of the world around them as well as their understanding of language difference.

Tips for ELL

1. **Understanding Dialogue and Characterization:**

Explain the concept of dialogue as a tool authors use to reveal characters' experiences and personalities through conversation.

Teach the use of quotation marks to indicate dialogue and introduce dialogue tags like "said" and "asked."

Highlight the significance of dialogue in understanding characters' emotions, thoughts, and relationships.

Student Activity: Character Dialogue Analysis

Provide students with a short story excerpt containing dialogue. Have them identify the dialogue tags, quotation marks, and the emotions conveyed through characters' words. In pairs or small groups, students can discuss how the dialogue helps them understand the characters better. This activity enhances comprehension and character analysis skills.

2. **Exploring Narrator's Voice and Point of View:**

Introduce the concept of narrator's voice as the perspective from which a story is told.

Differentiate between first person (character's viewpoint) and third person (external observer) narrative points of view.

Discuss how the narrator's voice impacts the reader's understanding of the story and characters.

Student Activity: Narrative Perspective Comparison

Select two short passages: one written in first person and the other in third person. Have students read both passages and identify the differences in perspective and tone. In pairs, they can discuss how the choice of narrative perspective affects their perception of the story. This activity enhances critical thinking and perspective analysis.

3. **Recognizing Dialect and Cultural Influence:**

Define dialect as variations in language pronunciation and vocabulary due to regional or cultural differences.

Explain how authors use dialect to create authentic and relatable characters.

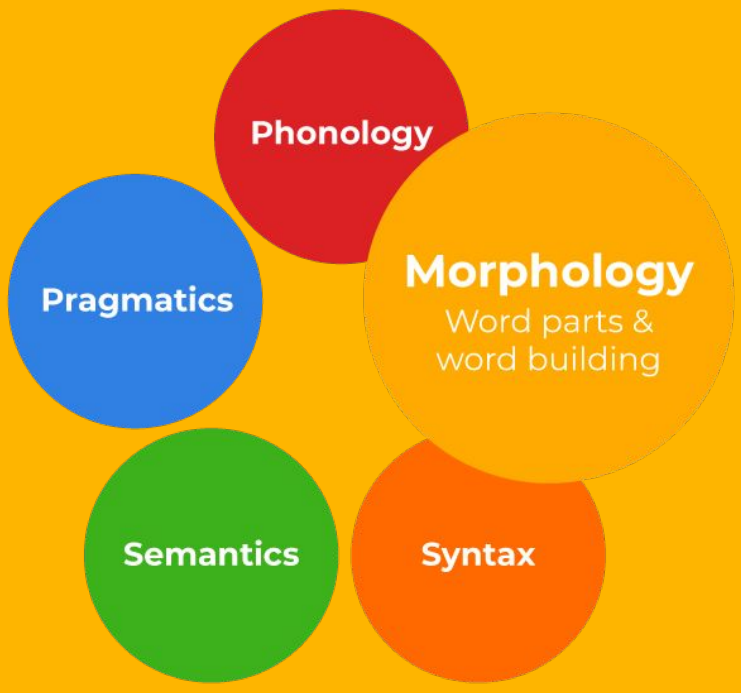
Discuss the concept of code switching, where language use changes depending on the context and audience.

Student Activity: Dialect Exploration and Code Switching

Provide students with short excerpts from different stories where characters use dialect or code switching. Have them read the passages and identify words or phrases that reflect regional or cultural language variations. In pairs, students can discuss how these language choices add depth to the characters and settings. This activity promotes cultural awareness and language analysis skills.

UNIT 18

Morphology: The Art of Word Building



PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Morphology: The Art of Word Building

What You Need to Know...

1. This unit offers students the opportunity to practice what they learned about prefixes (letters added to the beginning of a word), suffixes (letters added to the end of a word), and roots (whole words).

Potential Barriers

1. Students may find the redundancy of the practice challenging and may benefit from breaking up the lessons or adding them in as practice throughout the previous units.

Tips for ELL

1. Text Features: Charts, Graphs, Sidebars & Headings

Feature Exploration Scavenger Hunt: Prepare a variety of texts with different text features. Assign small groups of students a text to analyze. Provide guiding questions, such as "How does the chart/graph enhance understanding?" or "What additional information do sidebars provide?" Have each group present their findings, encouraging discussions on the purpose and impact of text features.

Student Activity: Have students create their own informative poster on a chosen topic using text features like charts, graphs, and headings. This activity allows them to apply their understanding of these features in a creative manner.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Morphology: The Art of Word Building

Tips for ELL

2. Paragraphing and Transitions

Paragraph Puzzle Activity: Distribute a text that lacks proper paragraphing and transitions. Cut the text into sections and mix them up. Have students work in pairs to reassemble the text in a coherent manner, ensuring correct paragraphing and adding appropriate transition words. This interactive task promotes collaboration and reinforces the importance of structure and transitions.

Student Activity: Ask students to write a short narrative incorporating at least three different transition words/phrases. Peer-review sessions can follow, where students provide feedback on the use of transitions in enhancing the narrative's flow.

3. Author's Craft and Reading Punctuation

Punctuation Detective Workshop: Select a passage rich in punctuation from a text. Discuss with the class how punctuation choices impact the reading experience. Then, have students work individually or in pairs to identify and explain the purpose of each punctuation mark. This activity sharpens their understanding of punctuation nuances.

Student Activity: Assign students a creative writing task where they incorporate specific punctuation marks for effect (e.g., ellipses, em dashes). Encourage them to justify their punctuation choices in a brief reflection afterward.